Venkatesh Subramanian

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Education

The University of Texas at Dallas, Dallas, TX, USA.
Ph.D., Public Policy and Political Economy — Expected 2027
Fields: Economics of Innovation
Committee chair: Dr. Dohyeong Kim
Committee members: Dr. Anne Burton, Dr. Natalia Lamberova, Dr. Pengfei Zhang
M.S., Social Data Analytics & Research — 2025
Graduate Teaching Certificate — 2024
Graduate Archer Fellow — 2023

The Takshashila Institution, Bengaluru, KA, India.
Graduate Certificate in Advanced Public Policy — Apr 2022
Graduate Certificate in Tech Policy — Dec 2020

National Institute of Technology Karnataka, Mangaluru, KA, India.
M.Sc., Physics — 2019

University of Madras, Chennai, TN, India.
B.Sc., Physics — 2017
"Best outgoing student of BSc Physics" award

Professional experience

School of EPPS, The University of Texas at Dallas, TX, USA.
Course Instructor, American National Government — August 2026-**Current**
See section on Teaching below for more information
Origins of Ideas lab, Research Assistant — Summer 2026
Facilitate validation of an AI-augmented data pipeline of researcher CVs
Manage a lab of 4 undergraduate students
Research Assistant to Dr. Natalia Lamberova — Summer 2024, Summer 2025
Contribute to a working paper on how aggregate shocks influence scientists' research agendas
Teaching Assistant — August 2023-**Current**

Center for Global Development, Washington DC, USA.
Summer Delegate — June-Aug 2023
Co-published a working paper (see below)

Cartesian Consulting, Bengaluru, KA, India.
Senior Analyst — July 2020-Jan 2022
Analyst — June 2019-July 2020

Analyzed the behavior of 10M+ customers of retail clients
Consulted with stakeholders from a 10+ person cross functional team
Awarded 'Rookie of the year 2019' and 'Employee of the year 2020'

Research

Doctoral Dissertation

Pushing and Pulling Antibiotic Innovation: Evidence from the National Institutes of Health and the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services

Bacterial Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR) has been recognized as a global public health problem with 1.27 million worldwide deaths in 2019 attributed to it. To combat the threat of AMR which is forecasted to worsen, policy recommendations have treated antibiotic drug innovation as an integral component. Several policy incentives are currently being explored to 'push' and/or 'pull' antibiotic drug innovation further with attempts being made to estimate the appropriate size of such incentives. My thesis does a similar exploration of the AMR innovation policy problem with a focus on US public institutions. I use reduced-form, design-based, causal inference techniques to estimate the impacts of existing US policy interventions which impacted the antibiotics market in the recent past.

Working Papers

Do Higher Health Insurance Reimbursements Encourage Antibiotic Innovation?: Evidence from Medicare's 2007 DRG Restructuring.

I estimate the impact of the 2007 restructuring of Medicare's Diagnostic-Related Groups (DRGs) in the US on the innovation of antibiotic drug patents. This restructuring had a first-stage effect on average hospital charges per stay (price of stay) reimbursed to hospitals with an average increase of $8,584 per annum for treating the most-severe patient across base-DRGs corresponding to bacterial infectious syndromes for 4 years following the policy change. Hypothesizing passthrough of hospital charges to pharmaceutical usage, I assess whether this first-stage effect in turn caused antibiotic drug innovation by comparing patent trends. But I do not find evidence for these second-stage effects on patent outcomes. To measure drug patent innovation, I attribute US drug patents to DRGs by mapping them to Medical Subject Headings (MeSH) terms in SureChEMBL, a publicly available patents database containing biomedical annotations. This work is salient in light of recent efforts by policymakers to develop novel 'pull incentive' mechanisms to hasten antibiotic innovation to ameliorate the burden of bacterial antimicrobial resistance.

The Cost-Effectiveness of Health Aid: An Exploratory Quantitative Analysis (as a second author of Victoria Fan, Brian Webster, Karen A. Grépin, David Watkins, and Joseph Dieleman) 2024. Working Papers 700, Center for Global Development. Repec URL

One approach to development assistance for health, or health aid, emphasizes the ex ante selection of cost-effective health interventions, an approach that began with the World Development Report (1993) on Investing in Health and has since been adopted by the Effective Altruism community. But just how much of health aid is cost-effective? In this paper, we examine projects in the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Creditor Reporting System, the standard dataset that measures and characterizes development assistance for health, for the years 2019 to 2021, and count the number of projects that refer to interventions from a list of highly cost-effective interventions as defined by the Disease Control Priorities Project, third edition. This exploratory quantitative analysis indicates that 61% of projects used a key word/phrase of a cost-effective intervention. There were 11.9 interventions mapped per project on average. There is little evidence that donors tailor the set of interventions to country income levels by cost-effectiveness. Policymakers may benefit from reviewing the full portfolio of interventions covered by domestic and external resources.

Work in Progress

The Role of Push Incentives in Encouraging Antibiotic Innovation: Evidence from the National Institutes of Health
Mesearch: Personal Experiences and Research Agendas (as a second author of Natalia Lamberova, and Mikhail Galashin)

Pre-PhD Publication

Structure of Protein Interaction Network Associated With Alzheimer's Disease Using Graphlet Based Techniques. (as second author of Ahamed Khasim, K. M. Ajith & T. K. Shajahan) 2022. In: Banerjee, S., Saha, A. (eds) Nonlinear Dynamics and Applications. Springer Proceedings in Complexity. Springer, Cham. DOI

Presentations

American Society of Health Economics Conference 2026 (both Presentation & Poster), MN, USA. 2026

Finalist, 3 Minute Thesis (3MT) 2026, The University of Texas at Dallas, TX, USA. 2026

Conference on Nonlinear Systems and Dynamics 2019 (Presentation), IIT Kanpur, UP, India. 2019

Fellowship

Graduate Archer Fellowship, Washington DC, USA Summer 2023
Wrote a policy paper on US federal legislation around digital advertising platforms
Met with legislative assistants, and legal counsels on the Hill

Grant

Dean of Graduate Education Dissertation Research Award, The University of Texas at Dallas, TX, USA 2026-2027
Awarded an $1,800 grant to acquire datasets for my dissertation research

Workshops

Wealth Data Science Summer/Winter School 2024, Constructor University, Bremen, Germany. 2024
Worked on a project visualizing a network of tax avoidance flows

Summer Program on Dynamics of Complex Systems 2019, ICTS, KA, India. 2019
Attended modules on Agent-Based Modeling (ABM), Graph theory, Game theory

Teaching

School of EPPS, The University of Texas at Dallas, TX, USA.

American National Government, Course Instructor Fall 2026
Administered a class of 129 freshmen from various majors
Designed and delivered weekly lectures (2.5 hours)
Designed the syllabus
Coordinated with a Teaching Assistant to manage students' emails

Research Design II, Teaching Assistant Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Spring 2026
Facilitated weekly recitations for grad students on causal inference, alongside grading duties
Created a grading rubric for augmenting students' AI usage in assignments

Research Design in the Social and Policy Sciences, Teaching Assistant Fall 2025
Delivered a lecture in-class, alongside grading duties

Topics in Science, Technology and Institutions, Teaching Assistant Fall 2024
Delivered a lecture in-class (Evaluation available here)

Approaches to Peace, Teaching Assistant Fall 2023
Delivered a lecture in-class, alongside grading duties

Volunteer services

The Centre for Effective Altruism
Volunteer Facilitator April-May 2022
Facilitated hour-long discussions for 8 weeks on Effective Altruism as part of the Introductory EA program

National Institute of Technology Karnataka
Physics Tutor July-Dec 2018
Volunteered to tutor in Physics to undergraduate engineers.

Languages English, Tamizh, Hindi

Skills R, Python, Stata, SQL, Git, Linux Bash, Latex, Microsoft Excel

Citizenship

Indian
Authorized to work in the US upto 3 years

References

Dr. Dohyeong Kim
Robert E. Holmes Jr. Professor of Public Policy, GIS & Social Data Analytics
The University of Texas at Dallas
dohyeong.kim@utdallas.edu

Dr. Natalia Lamberova
Assistant Professor of Business and Technology
The University of Texas at Dallas
natalia.lamberova@utdallas.edu

Dr. Anne Burton
Assistant Professor of Economics
The University of Texas at Dallas
anne.burton@utdallas.edu

Dr. Pengfei Zhang
Assistant Professor of Public Policy, Economics, and Cybersecurity
The University of Texas at Dallas
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